

- ❖ Use active voice.
- ❖ Use bullet points and numbered lists.
- ❖ Consider the audience and purpose.

Additional tips:

- ❖ Use a logical structure.
- ❖ Use clear and concise headings.
- ❖ Use proper formatting and layout.
- ❖ Use visual aids effectively.
- ❖ Use clear and concise tables and figures

UNIT – 3

ACTIVITIES ON PRESENTATION SKILLS

In business or in a student's career making presentations will be a part of the career all throughout. Therefore, attention must be paid towards honing the skills of effective presentation skills. Some of these presentations are made in formal situations and few in informal situations and most of the times these presentations are impromptu, meaning, a manager might ask an employee to discuss a technical topic at a staff meeting, so the speaker begins speaking without preparation or planning.

Presentations are of 3 kinds

Impromptu: are those where the time given for preparation is minimal

Extempore: are the ones where the time given for preparation is adequate. After adequate preparation, you can outline the speech and prepare lecture notes and

presentation aids, practice the presentation and then deliver the presentation with ease

Seminar: are those where sufficient time is given to write a research article that can be read out to the audience using suitable presentation aids.

Presentations can be oral in the form of JAMs or Oral presentations or Seminars.

JAM

Just a Minute or JAM is impromptu speech given in the time limit of one minute.

In this fast-developing global technology there is need for quick analysis and resourceful decision making. There is no extensive preparation and one has to speak innovatively at the spur of the moment.

Present a JAM on Artificial Intelligence

STARTING A CONVERSATION

Starting a conversation can be as simple as:

- ❖ **Saying hello:** Use a friendly greeting to break the ice.
- ❖ **Asking a question:** Show genuine interest in the other person.
- ❖ **Making a statement:** Share a thought or experience to spark discussion.
- ❖ **Using body language:** Smile, make eye contact, and use open posture.
- ❖ **Finding common ground:** Look for shared interests or experiences.

RESPONDING APPROPRIATELY AND RELEVANTLY IN A CONVERSATION

Responding appropriately and relevantly in a conversation involves:

- ❖ **Active listening:** Pay attention to the speaker and understand their message.
- ❖ **Acknowledging:** Show you're engaged with nods, verbal cues (e.g., "uh-huh"), or brief responses (e.g., "that's interesting").
- ❖ **Asking follow-up questions:** Clarify or seek more information to demonstrate interest.
- ❖ **Sharing relevant experiences:** Connect the conversation to your own life or knowledge.
- ❖ **Providing thoughtful insights:** Offer meaningful comments or perspectives.
- ❖ **Avoiding interruptions:** Let the speaker finish their thoughts before responding.
- ❖ **Staying on topic:** Refrain from changing the subject abruptly.
- ❖ **Using nonverbal cues:** Maintain eye contact, use open body language, and facial expressions.
- ❖ **Being empathetic:** Show understanding and compassion when appropriate.
- ❖ **Knowing when to transition:** Politely move the conversation forward or wrap up.

General Conversation Questions

1. What was the best book you read recently, and what did you enjoy about it?
2. If you could travel anywhere in the world, where would you go and why?
3. What hobbies or activities do you enjoy in your free time?
4. Can you share a memorable experience or moment from your childhood?
5. What's a skill or talent you've always wanted to learn or develop?

Work and Career Questions

1. What motivated you to pursue your current career or field of study?
2. What's the most rewarding project or task you've worked on recently?
3. How do you balance your work and personal life?
4. What's one piece of advice you would give to someone starting out in your industry?
5. What's the biggest challenge you've faced in your career, and how did you overcome it?

Lifestyle and Well-being Questions

1. What strategies do you use to manage stress and stay healthy?
2. How do you set and achieve personal goals?
3. What role does self-care play in your life, and how do you incorporate it?
4. What's your favorite way to unwind after a busy day?
5. How do you stay motivated and focused on long-term projects or goals?

Current Events and Opinions Questions

1. What's your opinion on a recent news event or trend?
2. How do you stay informed about current events and issues?
3. What social or environmental issue are you passionate about, and why?
4. How do you think technology is impacting our daily lives and society as a whole?
5. What changes would you like to see in your community or the world?

Personal Insights and Reflections Questions

1. What's a personal achievement you're particularly proud of?
2. How do you define success, and what does it mean to you?
3. What's the most important lesson you've learned in life so far?
4. How do you handle setbacks or failures, and what have you learned from them?
5. What values or principles guide your decisions and actions?

USING THE RIGHT BODY LANGUAGE IN CONVERSATION

Using the right body language in conversation involves:

- ❖ **Maintaining eye contact:** Engage with the speaker, but avoid staring intensely.
- ❖ **Smiling:** Show friendliness and approachability.
- ❖ **Uncrossing arms and legs:** Appear open and receptive.
- ❖ **Leaning forward slightly:** Demonstrate interest and engagement.
- ❖ **Using nodding and head movements:** Show agreement and attention.
- ❖ **Facing the speaker:** Give the speaker your full attention.
- ❖ **Using open and relaxed posture:** Avoid crossing arms or legs, which can indicate defensiveness or closure.
- ❖ **Gesturing appropriately:** Use purposeful gestures to emphasize points.
- ❖ **Mirroring body language:** Subtly imitate the speaker's body language to build rapport.
- ❖ **Being mindful of personal space:** Respect the speaker's physical boundaries.

ROLEPLAY DIFFERENT SITUATIONS:

❖ Seeking Clarification

You: "I'm not sure I understand. Can you explain that again?"

Me: "Of course! Let me try to clarify. [Insert explanation]"

You: "Okay, I think I get it now. Thanks for explaining!"

❖ Making a Request

You: "Hi, I was wondering if I could ask a favor of you. Can you help me with [task]?"

Me: "Sure, I'd be happy to help. When do you need it done?"

You: "By [deadline] would be great. Thanks so much!"

❖ Asking Permission

You: "May I use your laptop for a minute? I need to check something quickly."

Me: "Yes, of course! Go ahead."

You: "Thanks! I'll just be a minute."

❖ Refusing Permission

You: "Can I borrow your car for the weekend?"

Me: "I'm sorry, I don't feel comfortable lending out my car. Maybe we can find another solution?"

You: "Okay, no worries. Thanks for considering it!"

❖ Small Talk

You: "How was your weekend?"

Me: "It was good! I went hiking on Saturday. How about you?"

You: "That sounds fun! I just relaxed at home. Nice weather we're having, huh?"

Me: "Definitely! Perfect weather for outdoor activities."

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

Oral presentation is a formal address by a person to a group of people with or without using visual aids and other tools like slide show, video or audio clip and

power point presentations.

Oral presentation serves various purposes for students and others. Considering students, effective presentation skill can improve his or her chances of landing in a good career. It has become an important medium to gauge the strength of a candidate with regard to aspects like language competency, arrangement of ideas and persuasive skills. It is therefore advisable to improve oral presentation skill in a proper manner.

FOUR P s OF EFFECTIVE PRESENTATION

- ❖ Planning
- ❖ Preparation
- ❖ Practicing
- ❖ Presentation

FEW DO'S AND DON'TS FOR AN EFFECTIVE PRESENTATION

Do's	Don'ts
1. Do your research thoroughly Organize the data in an appropriate order. Prepare effective, appropriate, and clearly visible visuals and keep them in order. Ensure that visuals are properly visible to all the audience. Introduce the presentation content to the audience. Wear polite and pleasant expression and don't put on an act. Study the audience's non-verbal cues to understand whether they are getting convinced or not. Be persuasive throughout the presentation and make all efforts to retain the audience's attention.	Assume anything without researching. Leave any stone unturned in collecting data. Confuse the audience with inappropriate order of ideas. Present huge data in verbal form with a visual supplement. Block the view of the visuals. Give complete information in the introduction. Be careless about non-verbal communication. Ignore the audience's distraction. Argue or debate with any one in the audience to make them believe you.

JAM SESSION

Let's use the JAM session format to practice an oral presentation. Here's how we can adapt it:

- ❖ Choose a topic for your presentation.
- ❖ I'll ask you to speak about the topic for 1 minute, just like in a JAM session.
- ❖ After the minute is up, I'll give you feedback and ask questions to simulate a Q&A session.
- ❖ We'll keep practicing until you feel comfortable with the presentation.

DEALING WITH STAGE FEAR

Dealing with stage fear, also known as performance anxiety or glossphobia, can be challenging, but there are several strategies to help manage it:

what kind of strategies would you use to overcome stagefear

- ❖ **Prepare thoroughly:** Know your material inside out to boost confidence.
- ❖ **Visualize success:** Imagine yourself performing well and receiving applause.
- ❖ **Take deep breaths:** Relax and calm your nerves with slow, deep breathing.

- ❖ **Focus on your message:** Concentrate on the content rather than your anxiety.
- ❖ **Use positive self-talk:** Encourage yourself with positive affirmations.
- ❖ **Reframe your thinking:** View stage fear as excitement or energy.
- ❖ **Get familiar with the setting:** Visit the performance space beforehand.
- ❖ **Use physical relaxation techniques:** Release tension with exercises like yoga or stretching.
- ❖ **9. Seek support:** Share your concerns with friends, family, or a mentor.
- ❖ **10. Gradual exposure:** Gradually face your fear by performing in front of small groups.

UNDERSTANDING THE NUANCES (difference in expression) OF DELIVERY:

Understanding the nuances of presentation involves considering the following aspects:

- ❖ **Tone:** Formal or informal, serious or humorous, enthusiastic or professional.
- ❖ **Audience:** Who is your audience? What are their interests, needs, and level of understanding?

- ❖ **Purpose:** What is the purpose of your presentation? To inform, persuade, educate, or entertain?
- ❖ **Language:** Using clear, concise, and engaging language, avoiding jargon and technical terms unless necessary.
- ❖ **Visuals:** Using images, charts, graphs, and videos to support your message and enhance engagement.
- ❖ **Body Language:** Making eye contact, using gestures, and maintaining a confident posture.
- ❖ **Pacing:** Varying your speed to emphasize points, keep the audience engaged, and allow for absorption.
- ❖ **Emphasis:** Highlighting key points through tone, volume, and visual aids.
- ❖ **Transitions:** Smoothly connecting ideas and slides to maintain a logical flow.
- ❖ **Authenticity:** Being genuine, passionate, and transparent in your delivery.

PRESENTATION THROUGH POSTERS, PROJECTS, AND REPORTS

Presenting information through posters, projects, and reports requires a slightly different approach than oral presentations. Here are some tips for each:

Posters:

- ❖ **Keep it visual:** Use images, charts, and graphs to convey information.
- ❖ **Keep it concise:** Limit text to key points and use bullet points.
- ❖ **Organize:** Use clear headings and sections.
- ❖ **Color scheme:** Choose a few colors that complement each other.

- ❖ **Font size:** Use large font sizes for headings and smaller for text.

Projects:

- ❖ **Define the scope:** Clearly outline the project's objectives and scope.
- ❖ **Structure:** Organize the project into logical sections or phases.
- ❖ **Visuals:** Incorporate images, diagrams, or videos to illustrate key points.
- ❖ **Results:** Present findings and results clearly and concisely.
- ❖ **Conclusion:** Summarize key takeaways and recommendations.

Reports:

- ❖ **Clear purpose:** State the report's purpose and scope.
- ❖ **Structured format:** Use headings, subheadings, and bullet points.
- ❖ **Objective tone:** Avoid bias and use objective language.
- ❖ **Data support:** Use data and evidence to support findings.
- ❖ **Conclusion:** Summarize key findings and recommendations.

CHECKLIST FOR MAKING A PRESENTATION

Here is a comprehensive checklist for making a presentation:

Preparation

- ❖ Define the purpose and scope of the presentation
- ❖ Identify the target audience and their needs

- ❖ Research and gather relevant information
- ❖ Organize ideas and create an outline
- ❖ Set clear objectives and key messages
- ❖ **Content**
- ❖ Create engaging and informative slides
- ❖ Use clear and concise language
- ❖ Include visual aids (images, charts, graphs, videos)
- ❖ Use bullet points and headings to organize content
- ❖ Ensure accuracy and credibility of information

Design

- ❖ Choose a consistent and professional template
- ❖ Select a color scheme and font style
- ❖ Use images and graphics to enhance slides
- ❖ Ensure proper spacing and alignment
- ❖ Use transitions and animations judiciously

Practice

- ❖ Rehearse the presentation several times
- ❖ Practice in front of a mirror or record yourself
- ❖ Get feedback from others
- ❖ Time yourself to ensure you stay within the allotted time

Delivery

- ❖ Arrive early to set up and test equipment
- ❖ Engage with the audience and make eye contact
- ❖ Speak clearly and confidently

- ❖ Use body language and gestures effectively
- ❖ Handle questions and comments professionally

Final Check

- ❖ Review the presentation for accuracy and completeness
- ❖ Ensure all equipment is working properly
- ❖ Have a backup plan in case of technical issues
- ❖ Bring extra copies of handouts or materials
- ❖ Take deep breaths and relax – you're ready

Give a presentation on Elimination of Child Labour

RUBRICS OF EVALUATION

Rubrics of evaluation are criteria used to assess and measure the quality of a performance, project, or assignment. They typically include:

- ❖ Specific criteria: Clear and concise statements of what is being evaluated.
- ❖ Performance levels: Descriptions of different levels of achievement (e.g., excellent, good, fair, poor).
- ❖ Standards: Expected levels of performance or quality.
- ❖ Descriptors: Detailed explanations of what constitutes each performance level.
- ❖ Weightage: Relative importance of each criterion.

Rubrics can be used for various purposes, such as:

- ❖ Grading: Assessing student performance.
- ❖ Feedback: Providing constructive feedback.
- ❖ Self-assessment: Encouraging reflection and self-evaluation.
- ❖ Peer review: Facilitating peer feedback and evaluation.

UNIT – 4

ACTIVITIES ON GROUP DISCUSSION (GD)

Group discussion is an important part of selection process by organizations in their search for right candidates to help to do their business effectively. It creates an impression in the minds of the panelist regarding a candidate. It is a means to evaluate the ability to work with co- technocrats. The ability of communicating effectively and assertively in a group, to find solutions to the problem-oriented situations, analyzing the case logically in a case study are some of the aspects judged in the G.D round. In short thinking, analyzing, arguing, convincing, persuading are the mental abilities that are evaluated in this qualifying test.

G.D generally last for 10 to 20 minutes, since their will be 6 to 10 members in the group, one can speak not more than a minute and two. So the following four points have to be remembered:

- ❖ Listen carefully.
- ❖ Analyze what you are listening to.
- ❖ Think quickly.
- ❖ Talk briefly, precisely & relevantly.

TYPES OF GROUP DISCUSSIONS

There are several types of group discussions, including:

- ❖ **Structured Group Discussion:** A facilitated discussion with a clear agenda, goals, and rules.
- ❖ **Unstructured Group Discussion:** A free-flowing discussion without a set agenda or facilitator.
- ❖ **Role-Play Group Discussion:** Participants take on roles to explore different perspectives and scenarios.
- ❖ **Case Study Group Discussion:** Analyzing a real-life case or scenario to develop problem-solving skills.
- ❖ **Debate Group Discussion:** Arguing for or against a topic to develop critical thinking and persuasion skills.
- ❖ **Brainstorming Group Discussion:** Generating ideas and solutions without evaluation or judgment.
- ❖ **Problem-Solving Group Discussion:** Collaborating to identify and solve a specific problem.
- ❖ **Decision-Making Group Discussion:** Reaching a collective decision on a topic or issue.
- ❖ **Creative Group Discussion:** Exploring innovative ideas and solutions

through creative thinking.

- ❖ **Reflective Group Discussion:** Reflecting on experiences, actions, and decisions to learn and improve.

GROUP DISCUSSION AS A PART OF SELECTION PROCESS

Group discussions are often used as a selection tool in various settings, such as:

- ❖ **Job interviews:** To assess communication, teamwork, and problem-solving skills.
- ❖ **College admissions:** To evaluate critical thinking, leadership, and collaboration skills.
- ❖ **Scholarships:** To assess communication, teamwork, and problem-solving skills.
- ❖ **Leadership programs:** To evaluate leadership, communication, and teamwork skills.

In a selection process, group discussions are used to:

- ❖ Assess communication skills
- ❖ Evaluate teamwork and collaboration
- ❖ Observe problem-solving and decision-making
- ❖ Gauge adaptability and flexibility
- ❖ Identify leadership potential
- ❖ Understand diverse perspectives and opinions

- ❖ Evaluate critical thinking and analytical skills

DYNAMICS OF GROUP DISCUSSION

The dynamics of a group discussion involve the interactions, behaviors, and processes that occur among participants. Key aspects include:

- ❖ **Communication:** Verbal and non-verbal exchange of ideas, thoughts, and opinions.
- ❖ **Participation:** Active engagement, contribution, and involvement of group members.
- ❖ **Conflict:** Disagreements, debates, and differing perspectives that can stimulate discussion.
- ❖ **Collaboration:** Working together, sharing ideas, and building on each other's thoughts.
- ❖ **Leadership:** Emergence of leaders who guide, facilitate, or dominate the discussion.
- ❖ **Emotions:** Expression and management of feelings, such as enthusiasm, frustration, or empathy.
- ❖ **Diversity:** Exchange of unique perspectives, experiences, and backgrounds.

- ❖ **Decision-making:** Collective choices, conclusions, or recommendations.

Effective group discussion dynamics involve:

- ❖ Active listening
- ❖ Respectful dialogue
- ❖ Open-mindedness
- ❖ Clear communication
- ❖ Constructive feedback
- ❖ Empathy and understanding
- ❖ Flexibility and adaptability
- ❖ Shared goals and objectives

Dysfunctional dynamics can include:

- ❖ Dominance by one person
- ❖ Lack of participation
- ❖ Defensiveness or aggression
- ❖ Poor listening skills
- ❖ Unresolved conflicts

Here's a group discussion (GD) Exercise

- ❖ **"In today's digital age, social media has become an integral part of our lives. Do you think social media has a more positive or negative impact on society? Discuss the benefits and drawbacks, and suggest ways to maximize its benefits while minimizing its negative effects."**

MYTHS OF GROUP DISCUSSIONS

Here are some common myths about Group Discussions (GDs):

- ❖ Myth 1: GDs are only about speaking: Reality - Active listening, nonverbal communication, and teamwork are equally important.
- ❖ Myth 2: Dominating the conversation ensures success: Reality - Facilitating the discussion, encouraging others, and building on ideas is more valuable.
- ❖ Myth 3: Only extroverts excel in GDs: Reality - Introverts can excel by preparing well, listening actively, and contributing thoughtfully.
- ❖ Myth 4: GDs are about winning arguments: Reality - GDs aim to explore ideas, build consensus, and reach a collective understanding.
- ❖ Myth 5: Personal opinions matter most: Reality - GDs value informed opinions, data-driven insights, and respectful disagreement.
- ❖ Myth 6: GDs are unstructured conversations: Reality - Effective GDs follow a clear agenda, time management, and facilitation.
- ❖ Myth 7: Only the loudest voice gets heard: Reality - Good facilitators ensure all participants have an opportunity to contribute.

BODY LANGUAGE IN GROUP DISCUSSION

Body language plays a significant role in group discussions, conveying confidence, engagement, and attitudes. Here are some key aspects of body language to consider:

Positive body language:

- ❖ **Eye contact:** Maintaining eye contact with others shows interest and engagement.
- ❖ **Posture:** Sitting up straight and facing the group indicates confidence and attention.
- ❖ **Facial expressions:** Smiling, nodding, and showing enthusiasm demonstrate positive engagement.
- ❖ **Gestures:** Using open and purposeful gestures emphasizes points and shows confidence.
- ❖ **Inclusive body language:** Uncrossing arms, leaning forward, and facing others encourages participation.

Negative body language:

- ❖ **Crossed arms or legs:** Indicates defensiveness, closed-off attitude, or disengagement.
- ❖ **Avoiding eye contact:** Suggests lack of confidence, disinterest, or dishonesty.
- ❖ **Slouching or leaning away:** Shows disengagement, lack of interest, or

discomfort.

- ❖ **Fidgeting or distractions:** Indicates nervousness, impatience, or disinterest.
- ❖ **Aggressive body language:** Invading personal space, pointing fingers, or standing over others can be perceived as confrontational.

Tips for effective body language in group discussions:

- ❖ Be mindful of your posture and maintain eye contact.
- ❖ Use open and inclusive gestures.
- ❖ Show enthusiasm and interest through facial expressions.
- ❖ Avoid distractions and stay engaged.
- ❖ Be aware of cultural differences in body language.
- ❖ Use positive body language to encourage participation from others.
- ❖ Be authentic and genuine in your nonverbal cues.

Voice modulation in group discussions

Voice modulation in group discussions refers to the way you adjust your tone, pitch, volume, and pace to effectively convey your message and engage with others. Here are some tips for effective voice modulation:

Tone:

- ❖ Be clear and concise
- ❖ Vary tone to convey emotions and emphasis
- ❖ Avoid sounding aggressive or confrontational

Volume:

- ❖ Speak at a comfortable volume for the group
- ❖ Avoid shouting or dominating the conversation
- ❖ Use volume to emphasize key points
- ❖ Be mindful of background noise

Pace:

- ❖ Vary pace to add emphasis and keep engagement
- ❖ Avoid rushing or slowing down too much
- ❖ Pause for dramatic effect or to allow others to contribute
- ❖ Use pace to build momentum or create suspense

FLUENCY AND ORGANIZATION OF IDEAS

Fluency and organization of ideas are crucial in group discussions to effectively communicate and engage with others. Here are some tips to improve fluency and organization:

Fluency:

- ❖ Practice articulating your thoughts clearly and concisely.
- ❖ Use simple language to convey complex ideas.
- ❖ Avoid filler words (like "um" or "ah") and pause instead.

Speak at a moderate pace, allowing others to follow.

- ❖ Use transitions to connect ideas smoothly.

Organization:

- ❖ Structure your thoughts before contributing.
- ❖ Use a clear and logical sequence to present ideas.
- ❖ Group related ideas together.
- ❖ Use visual aids like diagrams or mind maps to organize thoughts.
- ❖ Summarize key points to reinforce understanding.

Additional tips:

- ❖ Listen actively and respond thoughtfully.
- ❖ Use bridging phrases to connect your ideas to others.
- ❖ Clarify and confirm understanding before proceeding.
- ❖ Avoid tangents and stay focused on the topic.
- ❖ Encourage others to contribute and engage.

By improving fluency and organization, you can:

- ❖ Communicate ideas more effectively
- ❖ Engage others and build consensus
- ❖ Enhance your credibility and confidence
- ❖ Facilitate productive and efficient discussions
- ❖ Achieve better outcomes and decisions

EFFECTIVE GROUP DISCUSSION STRATEGIES

Here are some effective group discussion strategies:

- ❖ **Active Listening:** Pay attention to others, maintain eye contact, and ask clarifying questions.
- ❖ **Clear Communication:** Articulate your thoughts concisely, avoid jargon, and use simple language.
- ❖ **Open-Mindedness:** Encourage diverse perspectives, avoid bias, and consider alternative views.
- ❖ **Collaboration:** Build on others' ideas, offer support, and work towards a shared goal.
- ❖ **Respectful Dialogue:** Maintain a positive tone, avoid conflicts, and address disagreements constructively.
- ❖ **Leadership:** Take initiative, guide the discussion, and ensure everyone's participation.
- ❖ **Time Management:** Keep the discussion on track, allocate time for each topic, and avoid digressions.
- ❖ **Encouraging Participation:** Invite quiet members to contribute, ask open-

ended questions, and create a safe space for sharing.

- ❖ **Summarizing and Clarifying:** Recap key points, ensure understanding, and address any confusion.
- ❖ **Flexibility:** Adapt to changing topics, be willing to compromise, and adjust your approach as needed.
- ❖ **Non-Verbal Engagement:** Use body language, facial expressions, and gestures to show interest and engagement.
- ❖ **Constructive Feedback:** Offer helpful insights, suggest improvements, and receive feedback graciously.

DO'S AND DON'TS FOR EFFECTIVE GROUP DISCUSSIONS:

Here are some essential do's and don'ts for effective group discussions:

DO':

- ❖ **Prepare:** Research the topic, organize your thoughts, and anticipate questions.
- ❖ **Listen actively:** Pay attention to others, maintain eye contact, and ask clarifying questions.
- ❖ **Speak clearly:** Articulate your thoughts concisely, avoid jargon, and use simple language.
- ❖ **Respect others:** Encourage diverse perspectives, avoid interrupting, and show empathy.

- ❖ **Stay focused:** Keep the discussion on track, avoid tangents, and summarize key points.
- ❖ **Encourage participation:** Invite quiet members to contribute, ask open-ended questions, and create a safe space for sharing.
- ❖ **Be open-minded:** Consider alternative views, avoid bias, and be willing to change your perspective.
- ❖ **Use positive body language:** Maintain eye contact, use gestures, and show enthusiasm.

DON'T:

- ❖ **Don't dominate:** Allow others to contribute, avoid monopolizing the conversation, and listen actively.
- ❖ **Don't interrupt:** Allow others to finish speaking, avoid cutting in, and show respect.
- ❖ **Don't be confrontational:** Avoid aggressive tone, personal attacks, and inflammatory language.
- ❖ **Don't go off-topic:** Stay focused on the discussion topic, avoid tangents, and keep the conversation relevant.
- ❖ **Don't be dismissive:** Avoid dismissing others' ideas, show respect, and consider alternative perspectives.
- ❖ **Don't use jargon:** Avoid using technical terms or complex language that others may not understand.
- ❖ **Don't be negative:** Maintain a positive tone, avoid criticism, and focus on constructive feedback.
- ❖ **Don't fail to summarize:** Recap key points, ensure understanding, and clarify any confusion.

UNIT – 5

INTERVIEW SKILLS

An interview is a conversation between two or more people, typically between an interviewer and an interviewee, with a specific goal or purpose. The interviewer asks questions to gather information, assess qualifications, or explore thoughts and opinions from the interviewee.

Types of interviews:

- ❖ **Job interview:** To assess a candidate's fit for a job or position.
- ❖ **Informational interview:** To gather information about a company, industry, or role.
- ❖ **Research interview:** To collect data or insights for a research study.
- ❖ **Media interview:** For news, publicity, or promotional purposes.
- ❖ **College, university, or graduate school admissions.**
- ❖ **Investigative interview:** To gather facts or evidence for an investigation.

Key elements of an interview:

- ❖ **Preparation:** Research, planning, and preparation by both parties.
- ❖ **Introduction:** Establishing the context, purpose, and tone of the interview.
- ❖ **Questioning:** Asking open-ended, closed-ended, or probing questions.
- ❖ **Active listening:** Paying attention to responses, taking notes, and clarifying doubts.
- ❖ **Follow-up:** Asking additional questions or seeking clarification.
- ❖ **Conclusion:** Summarizing key points, thanking the interviewee, and

outlining next steps.

Effective interview techniques:

- ❖ Open-ended questions
- ❖ Active listening
- ❖ Non-verbal cues
- ❖ Empathy and rapport-building
- ❖ Clear communication
- ❖ Note-taking

Remember, interviews are a two-way conversation. Be prepared, engaged, and respectful to make the most out of the interaction!

PRE-INTERVIEW PREPARATION

The pre-interview stage is a crucial part of the interview process. Here are some key aspects to focus on:

Pre-Interview Research

- ❖ **Company research:** Learn about the company's mission, values, products, services, and culture.
- ❖ **Job description analysis:** Study the job description, requirements, and responsibilities.
- ❖ **Industry research:** Understand the industry trends, challenges, and key players.

Pre-Interview Preparation

- ❖ **Review your resume:** Ensure your resume is updated and tailored to the job.
- ❖ **Prepare your story:** Develop a brief overview of your education, experience, and skills.
- ❖ **Practice common interview questions:** Prepare thoughtful answers to common interview questions.
- ❖ **Prepare questions to ask:** Develop a list of questions to ask the interviewer.

Logistical Preparation

- ❖ **Confirm the interview details:** Verify the date, time, location, and dress code.
- ❖ **Plan your attire:** Choose professional attire that aligns with the company culture.
- ❖ **Plan your transportation:** Ensure you have a reliable way to get to the interview.
- ❖ **Plan to arrive early:** Arrive 10-15 minutes before the interview to show punctuality.

Mental Preparation

- ❖ **Positive self-talk:** Boost your confidence with positive affirmations.
- ❖ **Visualization:** Imagine yourself acing the interview.

OPENING AND ANSWERING STRATEGIES FOR AN INTERVIEW:

Here are some effective opening and answering strategies for an interview:

Opening Strategies:

- ❖ **Start with a strong greeting:** Firm handshake, smile, and eye contact.
- ❖ **Use a professional introduction:** Clearly state your name and purpose.
- ❖ **Show enthusiasm and interest:** Express excitement about the opportunity.
- ❖ **Use positive body language:** Maintain eye contact, uncross arms, and lean forward.

Answering Strategies:

- ❖ **STAR method:** Structure answers using Situation, Task, Action, Result.
- ❖ **Be concise and clear:** Avoid rambling, focus on key points.
- ❖ **Use specific examples:** Illustrate skills and experiences with concrete examples.
- ❖ **Show, don't tell:** Demonstrate skills and qualities through stories.
- ❖ **Use positive language:** Frame answers positively, focusing on achievements.
- ❖ **Active listening:** Pay attention to questions, clarify doubts, and respond thoughtfully.
- ❖ **Highlight achievements:** Emphasize accomplishments, impact, and results.
- ❖ **Be honest and authentic:** Share genuine experiences, avoid exaggeration.

INTERVIEW THROUGH TELECONFERENCE AND VIDEO CONFERENCE

Here are some tips for acing an interview through teleconference and video conference:

Teleconference:

- ❖ **Choose a quiet space:** Minimize background noise and distractions.
- ❖ **Use a landline:** Ensure a stable and clear connection.
- ❖ **Dress professionally:** Even though they can't see you, it'll help you feel more professional.
- ❖ **Speak clearly and slowly:** Enunciate and avoid rushing.
- ❖ **Use a headset or speakerphone:** Keep your hands free and maintain good sound quality.
- ❖ **Take notes:** Write down key points and questions.
- ❖ **Be mindful of time zones:** Confirm the time and zone to avoid confusion.

Video Conference:

- ❖ **Choose a well-lit space:** Ensure good lighting and minimal shadows.
- ❖ **Dress professionally:** Wear attire that presents you in a professional light.
- ❖ **Use a high-quality webcam:** Invest in a good camera for clear video.
- ❖ **Maintain eye contact:** Look into the camera, not at the screen.
- ❖ **Minimize distractions:** Turn off notifications and find a quiet space.
- ❖ **Use a headset or ear buds:** Ensure good sound quality and minimize echo.

- ❖ **Be aware of body language:** Sit up straight and use positive nonverbal cues.

MOCK INTERVIEWS

Mock interviews are simulated interviews that mimic the real thing, allowing you to practice and prepare for an actual interview. Here are some benefits and tips for mock interviews:

Benefits:

- ❖ **Improved confidence:** Familiarize yourself with the interview process and reduce anxiety.
- ❖ **Identify areas for improvement:** Recognize strengths and weaknesses, and work on enhancing your responses.
- ❖ **Refine your responses:** Practice articulating your thoughts, experiences, and skills.
- ❖ **Get feedback:** Receive constructive feedback from the mock interviewer.
- ❖ **Enhance your performance:** Fine-tune your body language, tone, and overall presentation.

Tips:

- ❖ **Find a mock interviewer:** Ask a friend, family member, mentor, or career counselor to conduct the mock interview.
- ❖ **Prepare thoroughly:** Research the company, practice common interview questions, and review your resume.
- ❖ **Simulate the real thing:** Use a timer, dress professionally, and conduct the mock interview in a quiet space.
- ❖ **Be open to feedback:** Encourage honest feedback and use it to improve.
- ❖ **Record the mock interview:** Record the session to identify areas for

improvement and track progress.

Mock interview platforms and resources:

- ❖ **Online platforms:** Big Interview, Pramp, and (link unavailable) offer virtual mock interviews.
- ❖ **Career centers:** Many universities and colleges offer mock interview services.
- ❖ **Professional associations:** Industry-specific associations may provide mock interview resources.
- ❖ **Books and guides:** Utilize interview preparation books and guides for tips and practice questions.

Sample Interview

Interviewer: Good morning, Satish. Thank you for coming in today. How are you?

Satish: Good morning. I'm doing well, thank you. I appreciate the opportunity to interview for this role.

Interviewer: Great to hear. Let's dive right in. Can you start by telling us a bit about your background and experience relevant to this role?

Satish: Certainly. I have a background in sociology, which has given me a strong understanding of social dynamics and communication strategies. In my previous role, I managed a small team responsible for creating and curating content for various social media platforms. I also developed strategies to increase engagement and reach, which led to a significant boost in our social media metrics.

Interviewer: That sounds interesting. What specific strategies have you found effective in increasing engagement on social media platforms?

Satish: One strategy that worked well was analyzing audience insights to tailor content to their preferences and behaviors. We also ran targeted ad campaigns and collaborated with influencers to broaden our reach.

Additionally, we regularly engaged with our audience through comments and messages to build a strong community.

Interviewer: Excellent. Can you describe a challenging situation you faced in your previous role and how you handled it?

Satish: One challenge was dealing with a sudden negative backlash against one of our campaigns. To address this, I quickly assessed the situation, responded with a transparent and empathetic message, and took steps to rectify the issue. We also gathered feedback from our audience to understand their concerns better and used that information to improve future campaigns.

Interviewer: How do you stay updated with the latest trends and changes in social media?

Satish: I regularly read industry blogs, follow thought leaders on social media, and participate in webinars and workshops. I also make it a point to experiment with new tools and techniques to keep my skills current.

Interviewer: Finally, why do you want to work with our company, and how do you think you can contribute to our team?

Satish: I admire your company's innovative approach and commitment to engaging with your audience. I believe my background in sociology and experience with social media management would allow me to contribute effectively by bringing fresh ideas and strategies to the table. I'm excited about the opportunity to work with a forward-thinking team and help drive your social media success.

Interviewer: Thank you, Satish. It was great speaking with you. Do you have any questions for us?

Satish: Yes, I do. Can you tell me more about the team I would be working with and the key goals for the social media department in the coming year?

Interviewer: Certainly. We have a dynamic team that focuses on innovative content creation and data-driven strategies. Our key goals for the upcoming year include expanding our reach into new markets and

enhancing our engagement metrics. We're looking for someone who can help us achieve these goals with creative solutions.

Satish: That sounds like an exciting challenge. Thank you for the information.

Interviewer: You're welcome. We'll be in touch soon regarding the next steps. Have a great day!

Satish: Thank you, and you too. Goodbye.

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